aiPHeed Food Insecurity Forecast Report

What Is Driving the Risk

Area	Quezon
Period	2026 Q4
Date prepared	18 October 2026
Prepared for	DA Region IV-A
Data	2026 Q4 forecast, lead 1, issued 2026-10-01

The risk score ranges from 0 to 1. It is the estimated chance that the province's hunger-and-food-price score -- regional hunger from the SWS survey plus twice the gap between the province's food inflation and the five-province average -- is above its usual level, the median of the past published quarters. A higher score means this combined pressure is more likely to be above its usual level. It is not a measure of how many families lack food. This report uses three risk levels: Alert (0.60 and above), High (0.50 to below 0.60) and Not elevated (below 0.50).

Key Points

- In 2026 Q4, the risk score for Quezon is 0.92, which is at the Alert level.
- Food prices are the main factor behind the score, accounting for about 67% of the factors, and they raise the risk.
- Compared with 2026 Q3, the risk score increased by 0.03 (from 0.89 to 0.92).
- The 2026 Q4 value is a forecast issued 2026-10-01; its outcome is not yet known.

Risk at a Glance

Table 1 shows the risk score, risk level and main factor for Quezon in 2026 Q4.

Table 1

Risk Score and Risk Level for Quezon, 2026 Q4

Province	Risk score	Risk level	Change from 2026 Q3	Main factor
Quezon	0.92	Alert	Up 0.03	Food prices (67%)

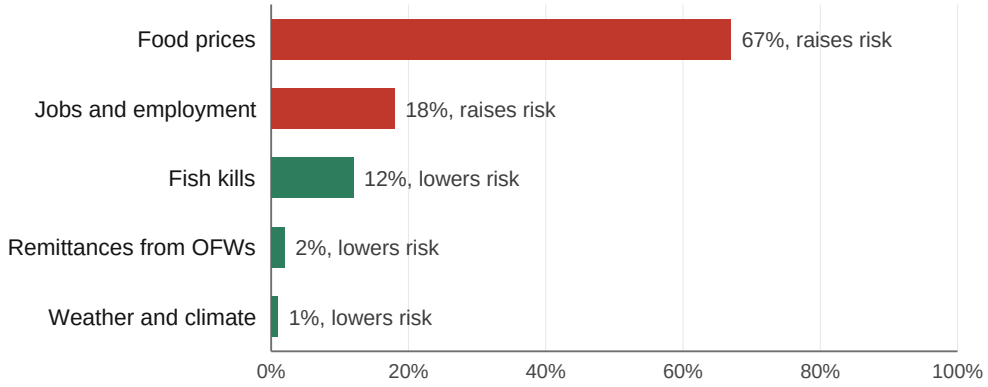
Note. Risk levels: Alert is 0.60 and above, High is 0.50 to below 0.60, and Not elevated is below 0.50. The main factor is the largest of the five factors behind each score. 2026 Q4: forecast, lead 1, issued 2026-10-01.

What Is Driving the Risk

As shown in Figure 1, food prices account for about 67% of the factors behind Quezon's risk score in 2026 Q4 and raise the risk. Jobs and employment account for about 18% and also raise the risk. Fish kills account for about 12% and lower the risk. Remittances from OFWs account for about 2% and lower the risk. Weather and climate account for about 1% and lower the risk. Compared with 2026 Q3, the share of food prices rose from 27% to 67%. Of everything behind Quezon's score, about 26% comes from the regional hunger survey and the last published result, about 6% from the tone of the news and news reports that match none of the five factors, and about 68% from the five factors shown in the figure.

Figure 1

Factors Behind the Risk Score in Quezon, 2026 Q4



Note. Each bar shows a factor's share of the five factors behind the risk score; factors with no noticeable effect are not shown. Red bars raise the risk and green bars lower it. These are the model's associations, not causes.

Table 2 lists the 10 model inputs with the largest effect on the score.

Table 2

Model Inputs Behind the Score in Quezon, 2026 Q4

Input	Value	Effect
Province food-price pressure in the first two months of this quarter	1.16	Raises (1.51)
Latest published risk label for the province	1.00	Raises (0.87)
Measured unemployment pressure (national, PSA LFS): rank against earlier quarters	75.07	Raises (0.66)
Measured market pressure: rank of provincial food and rice inflation (PSA CPI) against earlier quarters	76.19	Raises (0.49)
Province food-price pressure last quarter (PSA food CPI)	1.00	Raises (0.40)
Measured fisheries decline (proxy): rank of the fall in fish production (PSA) against earlier quarters	42.86	Lowers (0.40)
Food-stress tone of the province's validated news	0.00	Raises (0.24)
Latest regional hunger relative to the HIGH threshold	2.31	Lowers (0.17)
Change in regional hunger between the two latest surveys	-5.10	Lowers (0.17)
Latest regional hunger rate (SWS Balance Luzon)	17.30	Raises (0.14)

Note. Effect is the input's contribution in the model's own units (log-odds, before calibration). These are associations the model learned, not causes.

Province Profile

Table 3 gives basic facts about Quezon.

Table 3

Population and Poverty Incidence of Quezon

Province	Population	Poverty incidence
Quezon	2,260,669	19.7%

Note. Population is the total of the province's cities and municipalities in the PSA 2024 Census of Population (POPCEN). Poverty incidence is the share of people below the poverty line: Population-weighted mean of the PSA 2021 city and municipal Small Area Estimates of poverty incidence (2024 POPCEN weights), over the cities and municipalities with an estimate; Lucena City has none (highly urbanized city, not in the PSA no-HUC table). Derived by aiPHeed; not an official PSA province figure.

News Reports

One validated news report about food conditions in Quezon was published in 2026 Q4.

It was about food prices.

The tone of the news and news reports that match none of the five factors account for about 6% of everything behind the score; news matched to a factor is counted within that factor.

The news for 2026 Q4 is not complete: the quarter is still running and reports are still being collected. The 2026 Q4 forecast was built from the news of 2026 Q3: no validated news reports.

Important Notes

- The risk score is the estimated chance that the combined hunger-and-food-price score is above its usual level. It is not a measure of hunger or of how many families lack food.
- By the study's rule (at least 75% correct on past quarters), results one quarter ahead are the reliable horizon: 78% were correct on development data. Results two quarters ahead were correct 67% of the time, so the two-quarter-ahead value shown here is an experimental preview.
- City and municipal figures follow their province's score. They are not separate estimates for each city or municipality.
- This is not an official food insecurity classification. The report presents findings only; it does not recommend actions and should be used alongside DA Region IV-A's own guidance.